Testing Event 1 Report – Detailed Findings

Project: Canvas AI Assistant (Team 16)
Testing Event: User Testing 1
Date: July 14, 2026

Finding 1: Overall User Satisfaction Was High

The overall reception of the application was very positive. Most participants rated the application as either Satisfied or Very Satisfied, indicating that the MVP successfully met its primary usability goals. Only a small number of participants reported dissatisfaction, and those responses were primarily associated with issues involving the AI assistant rather than the interface itself.

Evidence:
- Participants consistently described the interface as easy to understand.
- Navigation was considered straightforward.
- The workflow felt logical and organized.
- The application looked polished and professional.

Interpretation:
These responses indicate that the overall user experience is strong and that first-time users familiar with Canvas were able to complete the required tasks with minimal assistance.

Finding 2: Interface Design Was the Strongest Aspect

The application's visual design was the most consistently praised component. Participants described the interface as clean, professional, intuitive, and visually similar to Canvas. The familiar layout reduced the learning curve and helped users navigate the system with confidence.

Common themes included:
- Clean and uncluttered interface
- Consistent colour scheme
- Organized dashboard
- Predictable navigation
- Professional appearance

Using a Canvas-inspired interface minimized cognitive load for users already familiar with the LMS.

Finding 3: The AI Assistant Was the Largest Source of User Issues

Although participants liked the concept of the AI assistant, they identified it as the area needing the most improvement.

Common issues included:
• Repeated clarification questions
• Poor conversation memory
• Forgetting previous prompts
• Incorrect or irrelevant responses
• Misidentification of students
• Overly restrictive guardrails

These issues indicate improvements are needed in prompt engineering, context retention, conversation management, and response validation.

Finding 4: Error Messages Were Not Informative

Many participants reported that system errors lacked sufficient detail. Users often could not determine what caused the error or how to recover.

Recommended improvements:
• Clear descriptions of failures
• Suggested corrective actions
• Better Canvas token validation messages
• Improved AI-specific error explanations

Finding 5: Canvas Connection Workflow Needs Improvement

Several users experienced difficulties connecting their Canvas account, particularly when using API tokens. Confusing validation messages made troubleshooting difficult.

Recommended improvements:
• Step-by-step setup wizard
• Better token validation
• Clear setup instructions
• Visual progress indicators

Finding 6: Preview Workflow Increased User Confidence

Participants strongly appreciated the preview and confirmation workflow before executing AI-generated actions. Being able to review assignment changes and generated messages increased trust in the system and reinforced the project's human-in-the-loop design philosophy.

Finding 7: Dashboard and Navigation Were Well Received

Users generally found the dashboard easy to understand and navigation intuitive. Course selection, viewing assignments, submissions, and dashboard information were consistently rated as Easy or Very Easy. Future improvements should focus on simplifying workflows rather than redesigning navigation.

Finding 8: Action History and Workflow Transparency Can Be Improved

Participants suggested improving the Action History page by moving summaries to the top, providing clearer descriptions, and making it easier to return to the AI chat. One participant also reported an incorrect student appearing in the Action History, indicating a potential integration bug.

Finding 9: AI Workflow Requires Fewer Steps

Several users noted that completing AI-assisted tasks required too many interactions. Reducing unnecessary clarification prompts and allowing more tasks to be completed from a single prompt would improve efficiency while maintaining confirmation before high-impact actions.

Finding 10: Functional Bugs Were Identified

Testing uncovered several functional issues including:

- AI repeating prompts
- Incorrect student selection
- Canvas token failures
- Rate limiting
- Non-functional buttons
- Assignment update inconsistencies
- Incorrect Action History records

Most reported bugs were related to backend integration rather than interface design.

Finding 11: Users Requested Better AI Guidance

Participants requested additional onboarding support, including example prompts, suggested tasks, printable instructions, and clearer descriptions of AI capabilities. Better guidance would help users understand the assistant's features and reduce uncertainty.

Finding 12:

There was a bug observed by me (Yerdana) and action was performed by the user. When user prompted the LLM to send messages to students, and the LLM returned an error (rate limit error) response, he re prompted by saying final exam reminder, and after LLM showed a preview of create assignment command for final exam reminder. Then he re-prompted LLM by combining prompt 1 (send a reminder to students) with prompt 2 (final exam reminder) and LLM finally fetched the correct response.

Overall Assessment

The testing event demonstrated that the MVP provides a strong user experience, particularly in its interface design, navigation, and human-in-the-loop workflow. The primary improvements identified relate to AI functionality, conversation context, error

handling, Canvas integration, and workflow efficiency. Addressing these issues before the next testing milestone will significantly improve usability and user confidence.